

Module 6: Refugees, Asylum, and Forced Displacement

Service Learning Project

Welcome Team: Supporting Refugee Resettlement or Asylum Seekers

Overview

Join a resettlement co-sponsorship team, asylum clinic support program, or campus welcome initiative, and compare the protection system as designed with the system as newcomers actually experience it.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Define refugee and asylum categories through real cases (UG 1)
- Describe protection systems as encountered in practice (UG 2)
- Compare migrant categories and their different entitlements (UG 3)

Suggested community partners

- Refugee resettlement agencies (co-sponsorship or welcome teams)
- Legal clinics serving asylum seekers (non-legal support roles)
- Every Campus a Refuge chapters or equivalents
- Mutual aid groups supporting new arrivals

Project steps

1. Complete partner training (confidentiality is central here).
2. Serve in concrete support roles: apartment setup, transportation, ESL practice, childcare during appointments, document organization (non-legal).
3. Track — without client details — which systems newcomers must navigate (benefits, work authorization, school enrollment, legal deadlines) and where friction occurs.
4. Map the observed journey against the textbook asylum/resettlement process from the module.
5. Write a field memo: where the system as designed and the system as experienced diverge.
6. Share themes (not cases) with the partner as a volunteer-experience debrief.

Deliverables

- Protection-system field memo (4 pages)
- Process map: designed vs. experienced
- Service log with partner sign-off

Time commitment

18–20 hours (resettlement support requires continuity).

Ethics requirements

Strict confidentiality; students never ask about persecution histories or legal case details.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Reliability and quality of service 30%	Exceptional professionalism: reliability and quality of service is confirmed by strong partner or site feedback; the student was consistently prepared, dependable, and left the partner concretely better off.	Solid professionalism: reliability and quality of service is confirmed by positive partner feedback; commitments were met with only minor scheduling or preparation issues.	Inconsistent professionalism: reliability and quality of service is partially met — missed sessions, uneven preparation, or partner feedback indicating the student required significant management.	Inadequate professionalism: reliability and quality of service is not met; commitments were unmet or the partner's experience was negative.
Accuracy of the system description 25%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: accuracy of the system description is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: accuracy of the system description is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: accuracy of the system description is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: accuracy of the system description is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Insight of the designed-vs-experienced analysis 30%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: insight of the designed-vs-experienced analysis goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: insight of the designed-vs-experienced analysis is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: insight of the designed-vs-experienced analysis is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: insight of the designed-vs-experienced analysis is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Professional handling of confidentiality 15%	Conduct is impeccable: professional handling of confidentiality is demonstrated throughout, protocols are followed without exception, and the work shows active care for the people and communities involved.	Conduct is sound: professional handling of confidentiality is evident with only minor lapses that do not affect participants or partners, and all required protocols are followed.	Conduct is uneven: professional handling of confidentiality is addressed but with gaps — a missed protocol step, careless handling of sensitive material, or boundary issues requiring instructor follow-up.	Conduct falls short of requirements: professional handling of confidentiality is neglected in ways that required intervention or placed participants, partners, or material at risk.